UNIVERSITY OF CANTERBURY | Tuihono Online

Qualification Opportunity Analysis

AI-Assisted Qualification Portfolio Mapping

ANALYSIS DATE

15th October 2026

IN-CONFIDENCE

ABOUT THIS REPORT

Introduction & Analysis Scope

Identify qualification opportunities that warrant further investigation by combining UCO market research with UCO's inventory of courses and qualifications.

The report supports qualification opportunity discovery, evidence review and further investigation across UC Online's portfolio.

Analysis scope

ANALYSIS TYPE
Full portfolio analysis

STUDY LEVEL
All

CITIZENSHIP
All

EVIDENCE ACCESS
No web access

Main areas of analysis

The analysis brings together UCO market research, portfolio and course information, and qualification information within the selected scope.

01 **Market & learner demand**
Market demand, learner interest, workforce need and relevant skills or capability signals.

02 **Competitive landscape**
Relevant qualification provision, competitor presence and market positioning identified in the available evidence.

03 **Portfolio fit**
Existing course capability, portfolio overlap, course alignment and confirmed reusable coverage.

04 **Development & feasibility**
Capability gaps, qualification structure, development requirements and areas requiring further validation.

Analysis approach

Market evidence is reviewed first, followed by learner and workforce need, competition, required graduate capabilities, portfolio overlap, course alignment, development gaps and qualification feasibility. Recommendations highlight areas that warrant further investigation and validation.

Interpreting the findings

Evidence strength, competitive context, confirmed portfolio coverage and development need provide complementary perspectives on each opportunity. Together, they show where market potential aligns with existing UC Online capability and where further development or validation may be required.

Uncertainty and areas requiring validation are highlighted where the available evidence does not support a firm conclusion.

OPPORTUNITY OVERVIEW

Qualification Opportunity Matrix

Evidence
Strength of the available market and supporting evidence for the opportunity.

Competition
Relative competitive presence identified in the supplied evidence.

Confirmed coverage
Relevant course points confirmed from the supplied UC Online portfolio data.

Development
Indicative level of additional capability development required to support the opportunity.

RANK	OPPORTUNITY	EVIDENCE	COMPETITION	CONFIRMED COVERAGE	DEVELOPMENT
1	**Applied, non-clinical Psychological Science** Extension Opportunity Master's · Level 9 · 180 points	Strong	NZ: Moderate–High / AU: High	75 pts · 41.7%	Moderate
2	**Professional Engineering** Extension Opportunity Master's · Level 9 · 180 points	Strong	NZ: Limited / AU: Moderate	65 pts · 36.1%	Significant
3	**Public Health** New Opportunity Master's · Level 9 · 180 points	Moderate	NZ: High / AU: High	0 pts · 0.0%	Significant
4	**Professional Accounting** New Opportunity Master's · Level 9 · 180 points	Moderate	NZ: High / AU: High	15 pts · 8.3%	Significant
5	**Business Information Systems** Extension Opportunity Master's · Level 9 · 180 points	Moderate	NZ: Moderate / AU: Moderate–High	55 pts · 30.6%	Moderate

Showing the highest-priority 5 of 8 analysed opportunities. Additional opportunities are included in the full report.

PORTFOLIO OVERVIEW

Portfolio Composition & Readiness

The supplied UC Online course portfolio is shown by subject area and lifecycle status, with capability signals from the validated analysis.

252 TOTAL COURSES

COURSE PORTFOLIO BY SUBJECT AREA



	SHARE	COURSES
Business	19.8%	50
Engineering	17.9%	45
Health	16.7%	42
Science	15.1%	38
Arts	12.3%	31
Education	9.5%	24
Other	8.7%	22

PORTFOLIO READINESS

Build Complete CURRENT	96	
Design & Build IN DEVELOPMENT	33	
QA/Testing IN DEVELOPMENT	1	
Scoping NOT CONFIRMED	15	
Not Started NOT CONFIRMED	83	
On Hold NOT CONFIRMED	24	

PORTFOLIO CAPABILITY SIGNALS

Reusable capability

Digital and data governance capability can support MBIS and Digital Health; applied research capability is reusable in some contexts; and engineering professional-practice courses provide an existing foundation. These capabilities support opportunities but do not replace domain-specific programme cores.

Recurring development gaps

Level 9 integrative and capstone capability recurs as a gap, while domain-specific professional cores remain a major constraint. Broad adjacent course availability should not be treated automatically as qualification capability.

HIGH-LEVERAGE DEVELOPMENT AREAS

Data governance & implementation

Advanced data governance and implementation capability in regulated professional contexts could support opportunities such as MBIS and Digital Health, provided the domain context is preserved.

Applied research & evaluation

Advanced applied research and evaluation capability could support multiple professional pathways where the capability remains flexible enough to operate across different domains.

DECISION OVERVIEW

Executive Summary

Six New or Extension Opportunities warrant further consideration. Applied, non-clinical Psychological Science presents the strongest balance of market evidence and existing portfolio capability; Professional Engineering shows strong workforce need but requires substantial technical and accreditation validation; Public Health has a credible New Zealand market signal but currently lacks confirmed advanced portfolio coverage.

#1

Applied, non-clinical Psychological Science

EVIDENCE
Strong

PORTFOLIO COVERAGE
41.7%

Best balance of credible demand and reusable existing portfolio capability.

REUSE-LED EXTENSION

Meaningful existing foundation

Existing UCO capability reduces the scale of new development, although additional domain-specific capability is still required.

#2

Professional Engineering

EVIDENCE
Strong

PORTFOLIO COVERAGE
36.1%

Strong workforce case, with technical formation and accreditation the principal constraints.

PROFESSIONALLY CONSTRAINED

Feasibility depends on external requirements

Existing capability supports the opportunity, but accreditation, professional recognition and technical formation materially affect feasibility.

#3

Public Health

EVIDENCE
Moderate

PORTFOLIO COVERAGE
0.0%

Credible New Zealand market opportunity, but substantial new advanced capability is required.

MARKET-LED BUILD

Credible opportunity, limited portfolio readiness

Market evidence supports further investigation, but limited confirmed coverage means substantial new domain-specific development is required.

SHORTLISTED OPPORTUNITY PROFILES

APPLIED, NON-CLINICAL PSYCHOLOGICAL SCIENCE

PROFILE 01

EXTENSION OPPORTUNITY

> Applied, non-clinical Psychological Science combines credible New Zealand postgraduate growth and broader online psychology interest with a meaningful UC Online foundation in psychology research, evaluation and wellbeing. Under current lifecycle and capability rules, 75 of 180 points are confirmed relevant (41.7%). The opportunity remains an extension rather than a near-complete reuse case and must be differentiated clearly from Organisational Psychology and registration-oriented pathways.

WHY IT STANDS OUT

Domestic Level 8/9 behavioural-science study and Applied Psychology EFTS show positive recent growth, while broader international psychology interest remains substantial. The strongest demand evidence is broader than this exact non-clinical concept, so positioning and differentiation remain important.

EXISTING FOUNDATION

OPSY619, OPSY622 and OPSY630 provide 75 confirmed points across wellbeing, research methods and applied research. They offer a useful foundation, but most existing Organisational Psychology content is not counted because it would not establish a distinct broader pathway.

DEVELOPMENT / VALIDATION NEEDED

The concept must establish a distinctive advanced non-clinical psychology spine beyond organisational settings and must not imply clinical or psychologist-registration outcomes that are not supported by the evidence.

NEXT VALIDATION STEP

Confirm with Psychology and portfolio stakeholders that the proposed broader non-clinical pathway can be differentiated clearly from Organisational Psychology and current psychology pipeline products before curriculum design proceeds.

SOURCES

Market Research_MS of Psy Scien_June 2026.pptx — slides 3–9 • 08072025_Market Insights report for University of Canterbury (Final).pdf — pp. 20–23, 57–63 • course_catalog.jsonl — OPSY619; OPSY622; OPSY630

SHORTLISTED OPPORTUNITIES · CONTINUED

PROFESSIONAL ENGINEERING

PROFILE 02

EXTENSION OPPORTUNITY

> Professional Engineering has the strongest workforce-led case, supported by a regional supply gap, postgraduate growth and professional-engineering demand. UC Online confirms 65 of 180 relevant points (36.1%) through engineering-management, sustainability, technology application and project capability. A viable professional pathway still requires discipline-specific technical formation, accreditation or professional-recognition mapping and practical requirements.

WHY IT STANDS OUT

Supplied research identifies sustained professional-engineering need, a regional online supply gap and stronger exact-title awareness in Australia than New Zealand. The case is strongest as a workforce and professional-formation opportunity rather than as an exact-title search-demand opportunity.

EXISTING FOUNDATION

EMGT602, EMGT605, EMGT606 and EMGT610 provide 65 confirmed points in engineering research, sustainability, technology application and project practice. They form a useful professional foundation but do not replace discipline-specific engineering science and design.

DEVELOPMENT / VALIDATION NEEDED

Discipline-specific technical formation, accreditation or professional recognition, and practical or applied engineering requirements are not established by the current portfolio and require formal validation.

NEXT VALIDATION STEP

Validate the accreditation pathway, discipline-specific technical requirements and practical or online-practicum expectations before determining the feasible qualification structure.

SOURCES

taught_MProfEng_research.pptx — slides 3–8 • Keyword Overview_Master of Professional Engineering.pptx — slides 3–5; slide 8 • course_catalog.jsonl — EMGT602; EMGT605; EMGT606; EMGT610

PUBLIC HEALTH

PROFILE 03

NEW OPPORTUNITY

> Public Health has a credible New Zealand search and enrolment signal but established competition. Under conservative lifecycle rules, UC Online confirms 0 of 180 relevant points (0%); adjacent Health provision and Not Started or On Hold courses do not form an advanced Public Health pathway. A Level 9 offer needs a coherent core in epidemiology, biostatistics, policy, equity and applied research.

WHY IT STANDS OUT

New Zealand qualification-search and enrolment evidence provides a credible learner-interest signal, while established New Zealand and Australian provision confirms a mature competitive context. Australian and international online learner demand is less directly established by the supplied evidence.

EXISTING FOUNDATION

Relevant Public Health, policy, equity, research and health-planning courses are present in the wider supplied catalogue, but the most directly aligned courses are Not Started, On Hold or require level and capability validation, so none are counted as confirmed coverage.

DEVELOPMENT / VALIDATION NEEDED

A coherent advanced pathway requires epidemiology, biostatistics, public-health policy and systems, Hauora Māori and equity, health promotion, planning, evaluation and applied-research capability that is not currently confirmed.

NEXT VALIDATION STEP

Complete an academic capability map to establish the scale of new Level 8/9 epidemiology, biostatistics, health-promotion, policy, equity and applied-research development required.

SOURCES

Market Research_MS of Public Health_August_2026.pptx — slides 3, 11–14, 21 • MPH NZ_AUS_INTL Analysis.xlsx — Sheet1 rows 6–30 • course_catalog.jsonl — PUBH421; PUBH422; HLTH464; HLTH302; HLTH312